



Rental Enquiry Checklist

For UAE car-rental companies: what to ask in the first reply, which documents to mention, and what to say up front so fewer bookings end in disputes. Free guide · September 2026

Renters often message several companies at once and book with whoever answers clearly first. In Harvard Business Review's study of online sales leads, firms that contacted a lead within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify it as firms that waited longer [1]. A complete first reply is the cheapest way to win more of the enquiries you already get.

1. The 8 questions for your first reply

#	Ask	Why it matters
1	Pick-up and return date and time?	Checks availability and price before anyone spends time on the lead.
2	Pick-up at your branch, or delivery? Which emirate / airport / address?	Delivery cost and driver scheduling depend on it.
3	Which car or category? Passengers and luggage?	Stops a sedan being quoted to a family of six with suitcases.
4	Daily, weekly or monthly?	Monthly renters are usually your highest-value leads: route them to a senior staff member.
5	UAE resident or visitor?	Decides which licence and ID rules apply (see section 2).
6	Driver's age?	The UAE minimum rental age is 21; some companies set higher limits for supercars [2]. Apply your own policy.
7	Which licence: UAE, GCC, home-country, or International Driving Permit?	Avoids a customer arriving at the desk with a licence you cannot accept.
8	Paying by credit card in the renter's name? Name for the booking?	Many companies take the deposit as a card block; say so before pick-up, not at the counter.

Tip: send questions 1–4 first. Ask 5–8 only once the customer is interested in a specific car, so the chat doesn't feel like a form.

2. Documents to mention, by renter type

The UAE Ministry of Economy and Tourism summarises the licence rules below [2]. Rental companies add their own conditions on top (for example, Hertz UAE asks residents for a UAE licence held for at least 12 months and a credit card in the renter's name [3]). Put **your** exact rules in the reply and review them when the authorities change them.

Renter	Licence (per UAE government summary [2])	Typically also requested (company policy — confirm yours)
UAE resident	Valid UAE driving licence	Emirates ID or passport copy; credit card in renter's name
GCC visitor	Licence issued by their home GCC country	Passport; credit card in renter's name

Visitor from a listed country (e.g. UK, USA, Germany, France, Canada, Australia, Japan)	Home-country licence accepted; see the ministry page for the full list	Passport with entry stamp/visa; some licences need an official translation [3]
All other visitors	International Driving Permit required, with the home licence	Passport with entry stamp/visa; credit card in renter's name

3. Say it up front (fewer disputes at return)

Topic	What to state in writing before the booking is confirmed
Deposit	Amount, how it is taken (card block or cash), and how long release takes after return.
Salik tolls and traffic fines	How they are charged to the renter, whether you add an admin fee, and when they are billed.
Mileage	Daily or monthly kilometre limit, and the charge per extra kilometre.
Insurance	What is covered, the excess the renter pays, and any optional full cover.
Fuel and late return	Fuel level at return and the charge if it's lower; grace period for late returns.
Travel outside the UAE	Whether crossing into Oman is allowed and what extra insurance or paperwork is needed.
Accident or breakdown	The 24/7 number to call. This must always go to a person, never a chatbot.

4. Handling licence and passport copies in chat

The UAE Personal Data Protection Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021) sets rules for collecting and processing personal data [4]. Practical habits that help:

- Ask for document copies only once a booking is agreed, not in the first reply.
- Collect only what you need for the rental, and tell the customer why you need it.
- Keep copies in one controlled place (not staff personal phones) and limit who can see them.
- Decide how long you keep them, and delete them when that period ends.
- Before connecting any chat tool, ask the vendor where data is stored and who can access it.

This is general information, not legal advice. Check your obligations with a qualified adviser.

5. The hand-over your team should receive

Whether a person or an assistant answers first, the salesperson who calls back should see one short summary, e.g.:

Car: SUV (7 seats) · Monthly · 1 Nov → 30 Nov · Delivery: Dubai Marina · Resident, UAE licence · Driver 34 · Card: yes · Name: Omar · Status: READY TO QUOTE

Example only; the details are fictional.

6. Want this running on your WhatsApp?

Mountain AI builds WhatsApp enquiry assistants for UAE car-rental companies. The assistant replies in seconds, asks the questions above using the rates and policies **you** approve, and hands your team a ready-to-quote lead. It never confirms a car or price by itself, and emergencies go straight to a person.

Step	What you get	Price
Free demo	A working demo built from your own website within 24 hours	Free
14-day pilot	Live on your number with your staff	AED 1,500, credited in full if you continue
Full setup	Your rules, handover to your team, monthly support	AED 7,500 setup + AED 1,250/month

Try the car-rental demo: mountainai-ae.com/demo/car-rental-assistant.html

Request your free demo: WhatsApp +971 56 777 3366 (message DEMO) or info@mountainai-ae.com

Sources

[1] Harvard Business Review, "The Short Life of Online Sales Leads" (2011): hbr.org/2011/03/the-short-life-of-online-sales-leads

[2] UAE Ministry of Economy & Tourism, "Renting a Car": moet.gov.ae/en/-/renting-a-car (accessed 28 Sep 2026)

[3] Hertz UAE, "Requirements to Rent a Car": hertz.ae/en/rental-requirements-2 (accessed 28 Sep 2026) — one company's policy, shown as an example

[4] UAE Government portal, "Data protection laws": u.ae/en/about-the-uae/digital-uae/data/data-protection-laws

Rules change. Check the official sources before relying on this checklist. Mountain AI is not affiliated with any company named above.